

THE MUTATION GRAPHS OF UNIFORM ORIENTED MATROIDS ON AT MOST NINE ELEMENTS ARE CONNECTED

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ABSTRACT. Cordovil and Las Vergnas conjectured that the mutation graph of uniform oriented matroids of fixed rank and size is connected. Knauer and Marc distinguish three versions of this graph — on labelled uniform oriented matroids, on their reorientation classes, and on their isomorphism classes — prove the labelled graph connected in rank 3 for every n , prove the conjecture for $n \leq 9$ at the reorientation-class level, and write that beyond rank 3 they know nothing about the labelled graph, where they suspect a counterexample exists. We show there is no counterexample below $n = 10$: for every rank r and every $n \leq 9$, all three graphs are connected. Once their rank-3 theorem, oriented-matroid duality and the elementary ranks ($r \leq 2$ and $r \geq n - 1$) are accounted for, the cases genuinely settled here are $(n, r) = (8, 4)$, $(9, 4)$ and its dual $(9, 5)$ — among them the case they single out as hardest. The method is a covering-space reduction expressing the number of components of the labelled graph as the index of a holonomy subgroup computable on the isomorphism-class quotient. Two by-products: the number of isomorphism classes of uniform rank-4 oriented matroids on 9 elements is 9,276,595, proved by a mass identity against a structurally independent extension count, correcting the value 9,276,601 printed by Fukuda, Miyata and Moriyama; and, when the isomorphism-class graph is connected and the holonomy surjects onto S_n , for odd n the number of components of the labelled graph is forced into $\{1, 2^{n-1}\}$ with no intermediate value possible. All computations are exact. Certificates and standalone checkers accompany the holonomy claims and the 9,276,595-class enumeration; §6 states precisely which claims they cover and which remain reproducible rather than certified.

1. INTRODUCTION

Let $\mathcal{M}$ be a uniform oriented matroid (UOM) of rank r on $E = \{1, \dots, n\}$, presented by a chirotope χ . A *mutation* of $\mathcal{M}$ flips the sign of a single basis so that the result is again a chirotope; geometrically, for realizable $\mathcal{M}$, it is the passage of one point through the hyperplane spanned by $r - 1$ others. The *mutation graph* has the UOMs of rank r on n elements as vertices and mutations as edges.

Cordovil and Las Vergnas conjectured that this graph is connected; the conjecture is recorded in [4]. Knauer and Marc [3] observe that the statement depends on which objects one takes as vertices, and separate three graphs, in decreasing fineness:

$\overline{\mathcal{G}}^{n,r}$ (labelled UOMs), $\mathcal{G}^{n,r}$ (reorientation classes), $\underline{\mathcal{G}}^{n,r}$ (isomorphism classes),

where reorientation means the action of $\{\pm 1\}^n$ (sign changes) and isomorphism the action of the full hyperoctahedral group $\{\pm 1\}^n \rtimes S_n$ (sign changes and relabelling). Connectivity of each implies connectivity of the next. Knauer and Marc state the Cordovil–Las Vergnas conjecture at the middle level. They prove, at the *labelled* level, that $\overline{\mathcal{G}}^{n,3}$ is connected for every n [3, Prop. 3.2], via Ringel’s homotopy theorem together with an explicit reorientation gadget; and they deduce $\mathcal{G}^{n,r}$ connected for $n \leq 9$ from a computation that $\underline{\mathcal{G}}^{n,r}$ is connected in that range. Of the finest level in higher rank they write that checking connectivity “is

far more demanding” and that they “do not know anything about the connectivity of this graph beyond rank 3”; in their conclusion they say they “suspect the existence of a counter example at least in the setting of $\overline{\mathcal{G}}^{n,r}$.”

Our main result is that no such counterexample exists below $n = 10$.

Theorem 1. *For every $n \leq 9$ and every rank r , the graphs $\overline{\mathcal{G}}^{n,r}$, $\mathcal{G}^{n,r}$ and $\underline{\mathcal{G}}^{n,r}$ are connected.*

The content is the labelled level; the other two follow. Much of the range is not new, and it is worth saying at once which part is. Ranks $r \leq 1$ and $r \geq n - 1$ are degenerate and elementary (§5); rank 2 is elementary as well; rank 3 is [3, Prop. 3.2], and rank $n - 3$ follows from it by oriented-matroid duality. What remains at $n \leq 9$ is rank 4 for $n = 8, 9$ together with $(9, 5)$, which is dual to $(9, 4)$. So the cases genuinely settled here are

$$(n, r) = (8, 4), \quad (9, 4), \quad (9, 5) \cong (9, 4)^*,$$

and it is $(9, 4)$ that carries the weight: its isomorphism-class quotient has 9,276,595 vertices, and it is the case Knauer and Marc identify as beyond reach. Theorem 1 does not settle the Cordovil–Las Vergnas conjecture, nor the labelled question, in general: it rules out a counterexample only for $n \leq 9$.

Two by-products deserve separate statement. The first corrects the literature.

Theorem 2. *The number of isomorphism classes of uniform oriented matroids of rank 4 on 9 elements is exactly 9,276,595.*

This value appears in Finschi’s database [1] and in [3, Table 1]; Fukuda, Miyata and Moriyama [2, Table] print 9,276,601, which is six too many. Our argument is not a third opinion but an exact integer identity: the orbit masses of the classes found by an exhaustive search sum to a target obtained by a structurally independent route, a single-element extension sweep over the 2,628 classes at $n = 8$. Under hypotheses made explicit in §5 — the enumerated classes valid, pairwise inequivalent, and carrying their true stabilizer orders, and the target exact — a search that missed a class falls short and cannot overshoot. The first three hypotheses are discharged by a standalone checker over all 9,276,595 classes; the fourth is reproducible but not independently certified (§6).

The second by-product explains why the labelled question at odd n is binary.

Proposition 3. *Let n be odd, let $\underline{\mathcal{G}}^{n,r}$ be connected, and suppose the holonomy subgroup H of §3 surjects onto S_n . Then*

$$\#\text{components}(\overline{\mathcal{G}}^{n,r}) \in \{1, 2^{n-1}\}.$$

For $n = 9$: either 1 or 256, with no intermediate value possible.

Finally, we record an erratum: [3, Table 1] lists 482 classes at $(n, r) = (9, 3)$. The correct value is 4382, as its own dual entry at $(9, 6)$, Finschi’s database, [2] and our independent generation all agree.

Verifying this note before reading it. The computational claims are machine-checkable, within the scope §6 sets out. From the repository

<https://github.com/reuellee/finite-certificates>

(directory `ai/omgamma`), with Python 3 and no third-party packages beyond `numpy` for the fast checker:

```

python verify_omgamma.py          # holonomy certificates
python verify_omgamma.py --canary  # self-test: must fail on a
                                   # missing artifact
python submodules.py              # Proposition 3, two methods
python coverage_checker.py --artifact data/coverage_4_9 \
    --extcount data/extcount_4_9.jsonl # coverage, all 9.28M
python coverage_checker.py --canary --artifact data/coverage_4_9

```

The last two need the coverage array, which is too large for the repository; §6 says how to obtain it, and how far each of these commands reaches. The ledger `ai/omgamma/OMGAMMA.md` records every computation, its artifacts, its trust boundaries, and its errata — including one of our own, discussed in §6.

2. THE THREE GRAPHS

Fix n and r . A uniform chirotope is an alternating map $\chi: E^r \rightarrow \{\pm 1\}$ satisfying the three-term Grassmann–Plücker sign conditions; χ and $-\chi$ describe the same oriented matroid, so a vertex of $\overline{\mathcal{G}}^{n,r}$ is the pair $\{\chi, -\chi\}$. Let

$$G' = S_n \times \{0, 1\}^n \times \{0, 1\},$$

$$((\sigma, \varepsilon, s) \cdot \chi)(x_1, \dots, x_r) = (-1)^s (-1)^{\sum_{i=1}^r \varepsilon_{x_i}} \chi(\sigma^{-1}x_1, \dots, \sigma^{-1}x_r),$$

where $\varepsilon = (\varepsilon_1, \dots, \varepsilon_n) \in \{0, 1\}^n$ records which ground-set elements are reoriented and s is the global sign. Here G' carries the semidirect-product multiplication induced by the S_n -action on $\{0, 1\}^n$,

$$(\sigma_1, \varepsilon_1, s_1)(\sigma_2, \varepsilon_2, s_2) = (\sigma_1\sigma_2, \varepsilon_1 \oplus \sigma_1(\varepsilon_2), s_1 \oplus s_2).$$

Throughout Sections 3–5 we work in the nondegenerate range $2 \leq r \leq n - 2$; the degenerate ranks are disposed of directly in Section 5. There the subgroup $K_4 = \{(\text{id}, 0, 0), (\text{id}, 1^n, 0), (\text{id}, 0, 1), (\text{id}, 1^n, 1)\}$ acts trivially on pairs $\{\chi, -\chi\}$, and we write $\overline{G} = G'/K_4$, of order $n!2^{n-1}$, with normal sign subgroup $\bar{R} = \{0, 1\}^n / \langle 1^n \rangle$ and quotient $\pi: \overline{G} \rightarrow S_n$. (Nothing below requires K_4 to be the *full* kernel; it is, in this range, but we use only that it acts trivially.) Then

$$\mathcal{G}^{n,r} = \overline{\mathcal{G}}^{n,r} / \bar{R}, \quad \underline{\mathcal{G}}^{n,r} = \overline{\mathcal{G}}^{n,r} / \overline{G},$$

and mutation is $\overline{G}$ -equivariant, so these quotients are graphs in the usual way.

3. FROM THE LABELLED GRAPH TO A SUBGROUP

The reduction is standard covering-space bookkeeping, stated for a group action that is *not* free — which is exactly where care is needed.

Lemma 4. *Let a finite group $\overline{G}$ act by automorphisms on a graph $\overline{\mathcal{G}}$ with connected quotient $\underline{\mathcal{G}} = \overline{\mathcal{G}}/\overline{G}$. Then $\overline{G}$ permutes the components of $\overline{\mathcal{G}}$ transitively, every component maps onto $\underline{\mathcal{G}}$, and for a base vertex v_0 ,*

$$\#\text{components}(\overline{\mathcal{G}}) = [\overline{G} : H], \quad H := \{g \in \overline{G} : g \cdot v_0 \in \text{comp}(v_0)\}.$$

For a chirotope χ and a basis B at which χ is mutable, write $\mu_B\chi$ for the chirotope agreeing with χ except that its sign on B is negated. If the class of $\mu_B\chi_c$ is c' , the *voltage* of that mutation edge is the element $t \in \overline{G}$ with $\mu_B\chi_c = t \cdot \chi_{c'}$ (as pairs); it is well defined up to $\text{Stab}_{\overline{G}}(\chi_{c'})$, and any choice may be fixed.

Lemma 5. *Fix class representatives χ_c and a spanning tree of $\underline{\mathcal{G}}$ rooted at c_0 . Define transports $\tau_c \in \overline{G}$ by $\tau_{c_0} = \text{id}$ and, along each tree edge directed away from the root, $c \rightarrow c'$ with voltage t , by $\tau_{c'} = \tau_c t$. Then H is generated by*

$$\underbrace{\{\tau_c u \tau_c^{-1} : u \in \text{Stab}_{\overline{G}}(\chi_c)\}}_{(i) \text{ stabilizers}} \cup \underbrace{\{\tau_c t \tau_c^{-1} : \text{every mutation edge } (c, j, c')\}}_{(ii) \text{ voltages}}.$$

Proof. ($\supseteq$) Induction along the tree gives $\tau_c \cdot \chi_c \in \text{comp}(v_0)$ for every c , mutations being $\overline{G}$ -equivariant. Then $\tau_c u \tau_c^{-1}$ fixes the component vertex $\tau_c \cdot \chi_c$, and $\tau_c t \tau_c^{-1}$ carries $\tau_{c'} \cdot \chi_{c'}$ to $\tau_c \cdot (\mu_B \chi_c)$, a neighbour of $\tau_c \cdot \chi_c$; an element carrying some component vertex into the component stabilizes it. Note this direction needs only that the tree paths exist, not that the search is complete, so elements harvested from a partial search are genuine members of H .

($\subseteq$) Let $g \in H$, witnessed by a walk $v_0 = x_0 \sim x_1 \sim \dots \sim x_k = g \cdot v_0$ in $\overline{\mathcal{G}}$. Write $x_i = s_i \cdot \chi_{c_i}$ with $s_0 = \text{id}$. Applying s_i^{-1} to the edge $x_i \sim x_{i+1}$ shows $s_i^{-1} s_{i+1} \cdot \chi_{c_{i+1}}$ is a mutation of χ_{c_i} , so $s_i^{-1} s_{i+1} \in t_i \text{Stab}_{\overline{G}}(\chi_{c_{i+1}})$ for the voltage t_i of some mutation edge $c_i \rightarrow c_{i+1}$. Hence $g = s_k h$ with $h \in \text{Stab}_{\overline{G}}(\chi_{c_0})$ and s_k a product of the $s_i^{-1} s_{i+1}$; inserting $\tau_{c_i}^{-1} \tau_{c_i}$ between consecutive factors rewrites that product as a word in the displayed conjugated families, which telescopes because $\tau_{c_0} = \text{id}$. $\square$

Family (i) is not optional: the action of $\overline{G}$ on chirotopes has nontrivial stabilizers, and omitting the stabilizer conjugates computes a proper subgroup of H . We learned this the hard way (§6).

Combining, with $\underline{\mathcal{G}}$ connected: $\overline{\mathcal{G}}^{n,r}$ is connected iff $H = \overline{G}$. For the middle level, the components of $\mathcal{G}^{n,r} = \overline{\mathcal{G}}^{n,r} / \bar{R}$ are the $\bar{R}$ -orbits on the components of $\overline{\mathcal{G}}^{n,r}$; since $\bar{R}$ is normal, $\bar{R}H$ is a subgroup, and Lemma 4 gives

$$\#\text{components}(\mathcal{G}^{n,r}) = [\overline{G} : \bar{R}H] = [S_n : \pi(H)].$$

So the labelled question becomes: compute a subgroup of $\overline{G}$ from data harvested on the quotient, and ask whether it is everything.

4. THE DICHOTOMY AT ODD n

Write $S := H \cap \bar{R}$ for the sign part of H . Since $\bar{R}$ is normal and abelian, conjugation gives $(\sigma, \delta, s)(\text{id}, \varepsilon, 0)(\sigma, \delta, s)^{-1} = (\text{id}, \sigma(\varepsilon), 0)$, so S is $\pi(H)$ -invariant. If $\pi(H) = S_n$ then S is an $\mathbb{F}_2[S_n]$ -submodule of $\bar{R}$.

Proof of Proposition 3. For odd n we have $1^n \notin E$, where $E \leq \mathbb{F}_2^n$ is the even-weight subspace, so $\mathbb{F}_2^n = \langle 1^n \rangle \oplus E$ and $\bar{R} \cong E$. We check directly that E is an irreducible $\mathbb{F}_2[S_n]$ -module. Let $0 \neq V \leq E$ be invariant and $0 \neq v \in V$. Since v has even weight and n is odd, v has a coordinate i in its support and a coordinate j outside it; then $v + (ij) \cdot v = e_i + e_j$ lies in V . The S_n -orbit of $e_i + e_j$ is all weight-two vectors, and these span E , so $V = E$. Hence $S \in \{0, \bar{R}\}$, and by Lemma 4 the number of components is $[\overline{G} : H] \in \{2^{n-1}, 1\}$. $\square$

The conclusion is corroborated computationally, independently of the argument: `submodules.py` enumerates the S_n -invariant subspaces of $\mathbb{F}_2^n$ for $n = 5, \dots, 10$ as sums of spans of weight classes, finding exactly four for each n ; for $n \leq 7$ it also enumerates *all* subspaces through their reduced row echelon forms and filters them, the totals 374/2825/29212 matching the Galois numbers (so that enumeration is provably exhaustive) and agreeing with the first method where both were run. A deliberately non-invariant subspace is rejected by

the invariance test. For even n an intermediate value is admissible; the full sign parts observed at $n = 8$ are therefore not forced by algebra.

Proposition 3 is not needed for the final verdict — the certificate exhibits a full sign span directly — but it explains the shape of the computation: at $n = 9$ the tracked sign dimension jumped from its minimum to its maximum with no intermediate value, and the proposition says no intermediate value was ever available.

5. THE COMPUTATION

Ranks $r \leq 1$ and $r \geq n - 1$ are degenerate: the three-term Grassmann–Plücker condition set is empty (it is nonempty only when $r \geq 2$ and $n \geq r + 2$), so every sign vector on the $\binom{n}{r}$ bases is a chirotope and every single-bit flip is a mutation; $\overline{\mathcal{G}}^{n,r}$ is then a folded cube, visibly connected. Rank 2 is likewise elementary: a uniform oriented matroid of rank 2 on n elements is a cyclic arrangement of n signed points on a circle, so its chirotope is determined by that cyclic order together with the reorientation, a mutation transposes two neighbours, and adjacent transpositions connect all such data. Rank 3 is [3, Prop. 3.2]. Rank 4 is computed exhaustively as described below. Ranks $5 \leq r \leq n - 2$ follow by duality. For a basis $B = \{x_1 < \dots < x_r\}$ with complement $E \setminus B = \{x_{r+1} < \dots < x_n\}$, the dual chirotope is

$$\chi^*(x_{r+1}, \dots, x_n) = \chi(x_1, \dots, x_r) \cdot \text{sgn}(x_1, \dots, x_n),$$

sgn being the sign of the permutation $(x_1, \dots, x_n)$ of E . Then $\chi \mapsto \chi^*$ is a graph isomorphism $\overline{\mathcal{G}}^{n,r} \cong \overline{\mathcal{G}}^{n,n-r}$ (and likewise for $\mathcal{G}$ and $\underline{\mathcal{G}}$), carrying the mutation at B to the mutation at $E \setminus B$ (verified computationally on all 135 classes at $(8, 3)$, among others). This covers every rank at $n \leq 9$.

For rank 4 at $n \leq 8$ (and, as a control, rank 3 at $n \leq 9$, where the answer is already known from [3, Prop. 3.2]) the quotient $\underline{\mathcal{G}}$ is small enough for an exhaustive breadth-first search harvesting both generator families of Lemma 5 at every class. In each case $H = \overline{\mathcal{G}}$, so all three graphs are connected; the rank-3 runs agreeing with [3] is one of this project’s regression controls.

The case $(9, 4)$ needs 9,276,595 classes and 150,561,898 directed edge traversals, run as a disk-based level-synchronous search. Completeness is certified by a *mass identity*. Every class c contributes an orbit of size $|G'_9|/|\text{Stab}(\chi_c)|$ labelled objects, and the total number of labelled uniform chirotopes is computed by a structurally independent counting route — counting single-element extensions of each of the 2,628 classes at $(8, 4)$, which touches neither the mutation graph nor the search:

$$\sum_{c \text{ found}} \frac{|G'_9|}{|\text{Stab}(\chi_c)|} = 1,722,704,635,330,560 = N_\chi(4, 9),$$

an exact integer identity, reached exactly. Provided the enumerated classes are valid, pairwise inequivalent, and carry their true stabilizer orders, and provided the extension target is exact, a missed class leaves the sum short and it cannot overshoot; under those hypotheses the identity proves simultaneously that the search visited every class — hence that $\underline{\mathcal{G}}^{9,4}$ is connected — and Theorem 2. Those hypotheses are conditions on this project’s own canonicalizer and extension counter, not on the search: a defective list carrying duplicates or wrong stabilizer orders could in principle overshoot. The first three are discharged by the coverage certificate of §6, checked by a program sharing no code with the generator; the fourth is not. Of the classes found, 8,913 have a nontrivial stabilizer.

The harvested holonomy is the full group: $\pi(H) = S_9$ of order 362,880 and the sign part full. Notably, on the shipped certificate the 73 stabilizer-derived generators are all even permutations and generate exactly A_9 , and a single edge voltage of odd permutation part supplies the remaining coset — so on that certificate family (i) alone does not reach S_9 . (We do not claim this of the complete family (i) over all classes, which was not enumerated: harvesting stops once H is full.) With $\underline{G}^{9,4}$ connected, Lemma 4 gives $[\overline{G} : H] = 1$, so $\overline{G}^{9,4}$, $G^{9,4}$ and $\underline{G}^{9,4}$ are connected, and (9, 5) follows by duality. This completes Theorem 1.

Remark 6. The computation was interrupted by an out-of-memory kill and resumed from a checkpoint. A resumed run harvests edge voltages only from levels expanded after the resume, so the subgroup it computes is a *lower* bound $H' \leq H$. Since $H' = \overline{G}$ was reached, $H = \overline{G}$ outright: a lower bound equal to the whole group is the whole group. The direction matters — for a negative verdict a lower bound proves nothing, and a completing pass over the earlier levels would be mandatory. The shipped summary records the lower-bound status explicitly.

6. CERTIFICATES, AND WHAT IS NOT CERTIFIED

The claims above rest on artifacts rather than on trust in the search programs, but the two halves rest on different artifacts and to different depths, and the first boundary below says how. Each completed case emits representatives, a spanning tree with voltages, generators, and exhibits; two checkers sharing no code with the generator — one pure Python, one **numpy** — re-verify the chirotope conditions, the group action, the mutation identity of every tree edge, the generator words, and the resulting group orders from scratch. Five sabotage mutations (corrupted representative, corrupted voltage, corrupted generator, truncated exhibits, re-pointed tree parent) are rejected, and the verifier fails loudly when a required artifact is missing, renamed or emptied.

What follows states the boundaries plainly, beginning with the one that is sharp enough to belong before the claims it qualifies.

The compact certificates prove $H = \overline{G}$; coverage is certified by a separate artifact, and only on one side of the mass identity. The compact (9, 4) certificates contain the root-path closure of the classes referenced by generators — a few hundred classes — which is what the holonomy claim needs and all that the checkers above verify. The left-hand side of the mass identity is a different object: the list of 9,276,595 class keys with their stabilizer orders. That list is now published as a checkable artifact: the keys sorted, each a 126-bit integer recording the signs of a chirotope on the bases in colex order, with each class's stabilizer order; 62 MB compressed, readable with **numpy** and nothing else, beside a manifest fixing the conventions and recording the SHA-256 of every array. Too large to track in git, it comes from an archived release or from regenerating it with the shipped code (about four hours); the manifest, which pins it by hash, is tracked. A standalone checker `coverage_checker.py`, importing nothing from this project and rebuilding the basis order, the Grassmann–Plücker conditions, the sign lattice and the group action from scratch, verifies in exact integer arithmetic that every key is a valid uniform chirotope; that every key is extremal in its own orbit; that the keys are strictly increasing, hence pairwise distinct; that every recorded stabilizer order is the true one, recomputed by exhaustively enumerating the admissible relabellings rather than by rerunning the generator's pruned search; and that the orbit masses sum to 1,722,704,635,330,560 with a count of 9,276,595. This was run in full, not sampled: every one of the 9,276,595 rows, in 510 seconds on four processes, all checks passing. Six sabotages — a duplicated key, a non-canonical key, a corrupted stabilizer order, a Grassmann–Plücker-invalid key, a truncated

array, and a stale hash — are each rejected. Each ships with a regenerated, internally consistent manifest, and with the totals repaired where they would otherwise betray it, so that none is caught merely by a checksum or by arithmetic.

Two qualifications, and they are not cosmetic. First, “extremal in its own orbit” is relative to the convention recorded in the manifest, which maximises over the relabellings respecting an invariant colouring of the ground set, not over all of S_n : the unrestricted maximum differs from the stored key on most classes and would cost some 160 CPU-days here. It is still a well-defined function of the G' -orbit, the colouring being invariant under reorientation and global negation and equivariant under relabelling; and that — not extremality as such — is what makes distinct keys certify distinct classes. A reader who wants that fact rather than the word “canonical” must read the forty lines defining the colouring. Second, the checker certifies the left-hand side only. The target 1,722,704,635,330,560 enters it as a constant; an option re-adds the tracked 2,628-row extension table and confirms that it sums to that number, but nothing recomputes the extension counts, nor re-derives the $(8, 4)$ catalog they are taken over. Those are cross-checked against every published count that exists, and the identity closes exactly in the smaller cases where the answer is independently known, but they are reproducible rather than certified. So Theorem 2 and the coverage half of Theorem 1 are certificate-backed on the enumeration, under a stated convention, and reproducible-only on the target.

One earlier observation was withdrawn. An intermediate report from this project described a structural phenomenon at $(9, 4)$: the sign part of the holonomy appeared to stay trivial over a large neighbourhood of the alternating oriented matroid, which was read as evidence that the labelled question there was delicate and perhaps negative. It was an artifact of a defect in the search engine, which computed the stabilizer of each newly discovered class and retained only its order, thereby harvesting family (ii) of Lemma 5 but never family (i). With the missing generators supplied the sign part is full immediately. The observation is retracted. The defect escaped notice because the smaller cases had run almost entirely through a different code path; the regression suite now forces the path that the large runs take. We record this because the failure mode is general: an incomplete harvest produces a plausible *negative* structural finding, and a negative finding is exactly what one is predisposed to believe when a counterexample has been conjectured.

RELATION TO [3]

Their rank-3 theorem $\overline{\mathcal{G}}^{n,3}$ is theirs and is used here; our labelled results add $(8, 4)$, $(9, 4)$ and $(9, 5)$, which is what closes $n \leq 9$. Our $\mathcal{G}$ results for $n \leq 9$ reprove theirs; the difference is not a stronger theorem but that the computation here ships certificates and checkers, whereas their connectivity computation — published in [3], with its method described there — is reported without publicly archived code, data or certificates. Their suspicion of a labelled counterexample is not refuted in general; it is refuted in the range $n \leq 9$, which is where they had verified the other two levels. Our Theorem 2 confirms the value in their Table 1 against [2]; the $(9, 3)$ entry of that table needs the correction noted in §1.

PROVENANCE

This work was carried out by AI systems (Claude, with adversarial review by Gemini and GPT models) directing exact computation under human direction, with deliberately-failing controls in every search and independent re-verification of the serialized certificates (with the scope limits of §6). No claim here rests on unverified model output: the verdicts rest

on those certificates and on the short arguments above, both checkable by the reader. The author directed the work and is responsible for the claims. The retraction in §6 was found by this process, not despite it.

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